

WHAT'S IN MY carry-on

Frequent flier *Nile Bijoux* shares five essentials he stands by when travelling light.



Travelling can be a nightmare. Security, passport checks, not knowing if your bags will make it to the same airport you do. But there is a way around some of that: travelling light. By that, I mean carry-on only. It's tricky, but it's very do-able.

These five items (not including fresh undies) will make sure your big holiday is as top-tier as it is in your mind.

Crocs, Classic Clogs

Starting from the bottom – a pair of good shoes is hugely important for travel. You want some that are easy to slip on and off but still comfy, and ideally breathable too. The best option? Crocs. Trust me.

They are fiendishly comfortable and easy to slip on and off. Perfect for the plane, and for walking around your destination. Alternatively, Birkenstocks are a great alternative – although they're a bit more expensive, with the popular leather/cork clogs priced at about NZ\$350 at the time of writing. **From \$119.99**



Technics, AZ100 earbuds

Technics' AZ100 earbuds are the best yet from the Japanese audio manufacturer, boasting new 'Magnetic Fluid' drivers which produce truly amazing sound, better programming to remove wind noise and other unwanted audio during calls in real time, and improved active noise cancellation.

I've used these on about a dozen flights now and they work extremely well, particularly for noise cancellation. They remove the roar of plane engines, and what little noise does get through is instantly drowned out by whatever you're playing through the entertainment system. The audio quality is also brilliant, but you'd expect that from the Technics brand. **From \$350**

Scrubs and creams

While you can sort of get away with a splash of water and a rub with a paper towel, travel-sized scrubs and creams are so easy to find that you really should have a couple in your toiletries bag.

I go with a Clinique For Men face scrub for general use (get the NZ\$63 100ml to avoid being pinged at security screening) and the 50ml Estee Lauder DayWear moisturiser (NZ\$125).

The former is brilliant for washing during a layover and the latter prevents your skin from drying out in the air-conditioning. I'd also highly recommend packing a lip balm, whichever your favourite is.

Panasonic, Palm-Sized 5-Blade Shaver

I use a Panasonic beard trimmer at home, and I enjoy it so much that I've started using



a pocket beard trimmer when I'm travelling and need a quick and easy tidy-up.

The Palm-Sized 5-Blade Shaver is my go-to, and it's extremely easy to use. Just hit the button and go.

The five blades give a nice shave, and it's waterproof so you can blast away at unwanted stubble in the shower if you're pressed for time. The one I have is made from an eco-friendly material called nagori, which reduces the plastic used by about 40%. **From \$699.99**

Instax, Wide Evo

The Wide Evo from Instax is a modern-day Polaroid, but with the new 'Degree Control' feature added. This allows precise adjustments to light and colour, along with 10 unique lens effects and 10 film effects.

It's a brilliant carry-on if you're into physical, Polaroid-style pictures, and an awesome way to document a trip – just don't forget to grab one of those little folders to protect all your prints.

You can also use Bluetooth to send the pictures to your phone via the dedicated Instax Wide Evo app to keep forever. The app is only for the Wide Evo, it doesn't work with other Instax models yet. **From \$649.99**

PHOTOGRAPHS TOP TO BOTTOM, LEFT TO RIGHT

The Technics AZ100 earbuds are superb for flying and negating all the surrounding noise. Panasonic's travel beard trimmer is compact but powerful. The Instax Wide Evo comes pre-loaded with a bunch of fresh film effects, as well as Bluetooth capability. After 10 hours or more on a plane, you'll want to feel as clean as physically possible. Crocs might still look a bit goofy but they're great travel shoes.

